

# Sales and Business Development English Jargon Quick Reference

Field-specific terms, contrast pairs, and high-pressure sentence frames

**Audience:** account executives, business-development representatives, sales managers, partnership teams, solutions consultants, channel managers, and revenue leaders

**Focus:** A sales and business development English curriculum for discovery, qualification, objection handling, pricing, procurement, enterprise buying committees, negotiation, partnership language, and CRM discipline.

Designed for advanced ESL learners who already use professional English and need industry-specific terminology, realistic meetings, role-play pressure, careful pushback, and polished workplace outputs.

Teaching stance: this is language and workplace-communication training, not legal, medical, financial, safety, or regulatory advice. Instructors should connect every scenario to the learner's current company policies, local rules, and approved procedures.

## Nomenclature and Jargon

These are classroom working definitions. Learners should adapt wording to their organization's policies, systems, and local regulatory environment.

### Discovery and Qualification

| Term           | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Collocations                                       | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| discovery      | In sales and business development, discovery is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to ask business questions before pitching features.      | clarify discovery;<br>document discovery           | Contrast: discovery should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify discovery and the evidence that supports it.           |
| qualification  | In sales and business development, qualification is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to ask business questions before pitching features.  | clarify qualification;<br>document qualification   | Contrast: qualification should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify qualification and the evidence that supports it.   |
| pain point     | In sales and business development, pain point is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to ask business questions before pitching features.     | clarify pain point;<br>document pain point         | Contrast: pain point should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify pain point and the evidence that supports it.         |
| buying process | In sales and business development, buying process is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to ask business questions before pitching features. | clarify buying process;<br>document buying process | Contrast: buying process should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify buying process and the evidence that supports it. |

### Value Proposition and Use-Case Fit

| Term              | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Collocations                                             | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| value proposition | In sales and business development, value proposition is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to connect product value to the buyer's actual workflow.        | clarify value proposition;<br>document value proposition | Contrast: value proposition should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify value proposition and the evidence that supports it. |
| use case          | In sales and business development, use case is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to connect product value to the buyer's actual workflow.                 | clarify use case;<br>document use case                   | Contrast: use case should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify use case and the evidence that supports it.                   |
| success metric    | In sales and business development, success metric is a defined information asset or analytical construct used to measure, explain, or predict an outcome. Use it when teams need to connect product value to the buyer's actual workflow. | clarify success metric;<br>document success metric       | Contrast: success metric should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify success metric and the evidence that supports it.       |

| Term        | Working meaning                                                               | Collocations                                 | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| stakeholder | Person or group with an interest, risk, authority, or dependency in the work. | clarify stakeholder;<br>document stakeholder | Contrast: stakeholder should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify stakeholder and the evidence that supports it. |

## Objection Handling and Competitive Pressure

| Term           | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                             | Collocations                                       | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| objection      | In sales and business development, objection is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to respond to objections without sounding defensive.      | clarify objection;<br>document objection           | Contrast: objection should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify objection and the evidence that supports it.           |
| competitor     | In sales and business development, competitor is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to respond to objections without sounding defensive.     | clarify competitor;<br>document competitor         | Contrast: competitor should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify competitor and the evidence that supports it.         |
| differentiator | In sales and business development, differentiator is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to respond to objections without sounding defensive. | clarify differentiator;<br>document differentiator | Contrast: differentiator should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify differentiator and the evidence that supports it. |
| total cost     | In sales and business development, total cost is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to respond to objections without sounding defensive.     | clarify total cost;<br>document total cost         | Contrast: total cost should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify total cost and the evidence that supports it.         |

## Pricing, Discounting, and Approval

| Term        | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                      | Collocations                                 | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| discount    | In sales and business development, discount is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to negotiate price without eroding value.           | clarify discount;<br>document discount       | Contrast: discount should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify discount and the evidence that supports it.       |
| procurement | In sales and business development, procurement is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to negotiate price without eroding value.        | clarify procurement;<br>document procurement | Contrast: procurement should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify procurement and the evidence that supports it. |
| margin      | In sales and business development, margin is a measurable indicator used to quantify performance, exposure, capacity, quality, or change over time. Use it when teams need to negotiate price without eroding value. | track margin; explain a change in margin     | Contrast: margin measures a result or condition; it does not, by itself, prove the cause. Example: Before we act, let us track margin by segment and explain what changed.                                                |

| Term          | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Collocations                                  | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| approval path | In sales and business development, approval path is a decision-accountability mechanism that clarifies who recommends, approves, performs, and accepts risk. Use it when teams need to negotiate price without eroding value. | clarify approval path; document approval path | Contrast: approval path should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify approval path and the evidence that supports it. |

## Enterprise Buying Committees

| Term              | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | Collocations                                          | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| champion          | In sales and business development, champion is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to navigate multiple stakeholders and hidden blockers.                       | clarify champion; document champion                   | Contrast: champion should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify champion and the evidence that supports it.                   |
| economic buyer    | In sales and business development, economic buyer is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to navigate multiple stakeholders and hidden blockers.                 | clarify economic buyer; document economic buyer       | Contrast: economic buyer should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify economic buyer and the evidence that supports it.       |
| buying committee  | In sales and business development, buying committee is a decision-accountability mechanism that clarifies who recommends, approves, performs, and accepts risk. Use it when teams need to navigate multiple stakeholders and hidden blockers. | clarify buying committee; document buying committee   | Contrast: buying committee should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify buying committee and the evidence that supports it.   |
| forecast category | In sales and business development, forecast category is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to navigate multiple stakeholders and hidden blockers.              | clarify forecast category; document forecast category | Contrast: forecast category should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify forecast category and the evidence that supports it. |

## Negotiation and Contract Redlines

| Term      | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | Collocations                          | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-----------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| redline   | In sales and business development, redline is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to keep commercial momentum while respecting legal boundaries.   | clarify redline; document redline     | Contrast: redline should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify redline and the evidence that supports it.     |
| liability | In sales and business development, liability is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to keep commercial momentum while respecting legal boundaries. | clarify liability; document liability | Contrast: liability should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify liability and the evidence that supports it. |

| Term            | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | Collocations                                         | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| indemnity       | In sales and business development, indemnity is a negotiated legal or commercial arrangement that allocates rights, obligations, remedies, or risk. Use it when teams need to keep commercial momentum while respecting legal boundaries. | clarify indemnity;<br>document indemnity             | Contrast: indemnity should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify indemnity and the evidence that supports it.             |
| commercial term | In sales and business development, commercial term is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to keep commercial momentum while respecting legal boundaries.    | clarify commercial term;<br>document commercial term | Contrast: commercial term should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify commercial term and the evidence that supports it. |

## Partnerships and Channel Development

| Term            | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Collocations                                         | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                                       |
|-----------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| channel partner | In sales and business development, channel partner is a stakeholder category whose needs, eligibility, experience, or obligations affect the decision. Use it when teams need to define partnership value and responsibilities.        | clarify channel partner;<br>document channel partner | Contrast: channel partner should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify channel partner and the evidence that supports it. |
| exclusivity     | In sales and business development, exclusivity is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to define partnership value and responsibilities.                  | clarify exclusivity;<br>document exclusivity         | Contrast: exclusivity should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify exclusivity and the evidence that supports it.         |
| pipeline        | In sales and business development, pipeline is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to define partnership value and responsibilities.                     | clarify pipeline;<br>document pipeline               | Contrast: pipeline should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify pipeline and the evidence that supports it.               |
| enablement      | In sales and business development, enablement is a capability or authorization process used to prepare, verify, or document that a person can perform a role. Use it when teams need to define partnership value and responsibilities. | clarify enablement;<br>document enablement           | Contrast: enablement should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify enablement and the evidence that supports it.           |

## CRM Hygiene and Pipeline Reviews

| Term | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Collocations              | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                               |
|------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| CRM  | In sales and business development, CRM is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss pipeline honestly under target pressure. | clarify CRM; document CRM | Contrast: CRM should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify CRM and the evidence that supports it. |

| Term       | Working meaning                                                                                                                                                                                                        | Collocations                               | Contrast and workplace line                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| pipeline   | In sales and business development, pipeline is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss pipeline honestly under target pressure.   | clarify pipeline;<br>document pipeline     | Contrast: pipeline should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify pipeline and the evidence that supports it.     |
| close date | In sales and business development, close date is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss pipeline honestly under target pressure. | clarify close date;<br>document close date | Contrast: close date should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify close date and the evidence that supports it. |
| commit     | In sales and business development, commit is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss pipeline honestly under target pressure.     | clarify commit;<br>document commit         | Contrast: commit should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify commit and the evidence that supports it.         |
| slippage   | In sales and business development, slippage is a field-specific concept used to locate the relevant fact, boundary, or decision variable. Use it when teams need to discuss pipeline honestly under target pressure.   | clarify slippage;<br>document slippage     | Contrast: slippage should be defined against the relevant evidence and decision boundary, rather than used as a vague label. Example: Before we proceed, please clarify slippage and the evidence that supports it.     |

## Industry-Specific Meeting Moves

| Situation                                   | Useful language                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Discovery and Qualification                 | Before we commit, I want to confirm discovery, qualification, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If pain, priority, authority, timeline, and business impact need qualification., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.       |
| Value Proposition and Use-Case Fit          | Before we commit, I want to confirm value proposition, use case, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If use case, stakeholder value, success metric, and urgency need definition., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.       |
| Objection Handling and Competitive Pressure | Before we commit, I want to confirm objection, competitor, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If total value, risk, scope, implementation, and commercial terms need comparison., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.       |
| Pricing, Discounting, and Approval          | Before we commit, I want to confirm discount, procurement, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If pricing policy, margin, term length, volume, and approval path must be reviewed., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.      |
| Enterprise Buying Committees                | Before we commit, I want to confirm champion, economic buyer, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If decision criteria, legal, security, finance, and executive sponsor status matter., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.  |
| Negotiation and Contract Redlines           | Before we commit, I want to confirm redline, liability, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If risk allocation, legal approval, insurance, and business value need decision., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step.            |
| Partnerships and Channel Development        | Before we commit, I want to confirm channel partner, exclusivity, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If territory, targets, enablement, economics, and performance gates need clarity., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step. |

| Situation                        | Useful language                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |
|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| CRM Hygiene and Pipeline Reviews | Before we commit, I want to confirm CRM, pipeline, the owner, and the evidence behind the decision. If next step, close date, buyer evidence, and risk should drive forecast accuracy., I recommend we document the risk and agree on the next step. |

## High-pressure pushback frames

- I understand the urgency. The risk is that we move faster than the evidence or process supports.
- I am not blocking the goal. I am naming the condition we need before the decision is safe and credible.
- If we accept this risk, we should name the owner, document the assumption, and define the trigger for escalation.
- That may be possible, but not under the current scope, timeline, or approval path.
- Let's separate what we know, what we assume, and what still needs confirmation.

## Contrast Pairs

| Do not confuse                   | Useful distinction                                                                                                                                                                         |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| discovery vs buying process      | In discovery and qualification, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.                 |
| value proposition vs stakeholder | In value proposition and use-case fit, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.          |
| objection vs total cost          | In objection handling and competitive pressure, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision. |
| discount vs approval path        | In pricing, discounting, and approval, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.          |
| champion vs forecast category    | In enterprise buying committees, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.                |
| redline vs commercial term       | In negotiation and contract redlines, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.           |
| channel partner vs enablement    | In partnerships and channel development, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.        |
| CRM vs slippage                  | In crm hygiene and pipeline reviews, define whether the discussion is about the current fact pattern, the controlling process, the stakeholder pressure, or the final decision.            |